# Class 6 Social Science – Chapter 4

## Timeline and Sources of History

नीचे आपके दिए गए NCERT पाठ के आधार पर सभी मुख्य विषयों की व्याख्या, पाठ के अंत में दिए गए प्रश्नों के उत्तर तथा प्रत्येक टॉपिक से महत्वपूर्ण संभावित प्रश्न-उत्तर Simple English में दिए गए हैं। भाषा कक्षा 6 के विद्यार्थियों के स्तर के अनुसार रखी गई है।

## 1. Textbook Questions and Answers

### Q1. As a project, write the history of your family (or village if you live in one), using sources of history at your disposal.

Answer:

My family has a long history. I collected information from my parents, grandparents, old photographs, documents and family records. I learned about the names, occupations and birthplaces of my ancestors. These sources helped me understand how my family lived in the past and how its life has changed over time.

Note: Students should add the real names, occupations and details of their own family or village.

### Q2. Can we compare historians to detectives? Give reasons for your answers.

Answer:

Yes, historians can be compared to detectives. Detectives collect clues to solve a case, while historians collect information from coins, inscriptions, monuments, books, tools and other sources. They compare different sources and check whether the information is reliable. In this way, they try to understand and reconstruct the past.

### Q3. A few exercises with dates

(a) Place these dates chronologically on the timeline:

323 CE, 323 BCE, 100 CE, 100 BCE, 1900 BCE, 1090 CE, 2024 CE.

Answer (earliest to latest):

1900 BCE → 323 BCE → 100 BCE → 100 CE → 323 CE → 1090 CE → 2024 CE

(b) If King Chandragupta was born in 320 CE, which century did he belong to? And how many years was that after the Buddha's birth?

Answer:

- The year 320 CE belongs to the 4th century CE (301–400 CE).
- The textbook gives 560 BCE as the approximate year of the Buddha's birth.
- Years between 560 BCE and 320 CE = 560 + 320 − 1 = 879 years.

The subtraction of 1 is necessary because there is no year zero.

(c) Rani of Jhansi was born in 1828. Which century did she belong to? How many years was that before India's Independence?

Answer:

- Rani of Jhansi was born in 1828 CE, so she belonged to the 19th century CE (1801–1900 CE).
- India became independent in 1947.
- Difference = 1947 − 1828 = 119 years.

(d) Turn "12,000 years ago" into a date.

Answer:

If we take the present year as 2026 CE, 12,000 years ago was approximately 9975 BCE.

Calculation: 12,000 − 2026 + 1 = 9975 BCE.

The answer is approximate because the textbook does not specify a reference year for this question.

## Q4. Plan a visit to a nearby museum. Write a brief report afterwards.

Sample Answer: Museum Visit Report

Name of the Museum: National Museum, New Delhi

Purpose of Visit: To learn about the past through historical objects.

I visited a museum to learn about history. I saw old coins, sculptures, ornaments and other objects. These objects helped me understand the art, culture and lifestyle of people in the past. I learned that museums preserve important objects for future generations. The visit was educational and interesting.

Note: This is a sample report. Students should write about the museum they actually visit.

### Q5. Invite an archaeologist or a historian to your school and ask them to speak on the history of your region and why it is important to know it.

Sample Answer:

We can invite a historian or an archaeologist to our school. They can explain the history, important places, old buildings and cultural traditions of our region. Knowing local history helps us understand our roots, respect our heritage and learn how people lived in the past.

# 2. Important Questions and Answers from Every Topic

# Topic A: How Do We Learn About the Past?

### Q1. What is history?

Answer: History is the study of the human past.

### Q2. Why do we study history?

Answer: We study history to understand how people lived in the past and how our present world developed.

### Q3. How does the past help us understand the present?

Answer: The past explains the origin of our traditions, societies, cultures and institutions. It helps us understand why the world is the way it is today.

### Q4. How long have modern humans lived on Earth?

Answer: Modern humans, called Homo sapiens, have lived on Earth for about 300,000 years.

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### Q5. Do humans occupy most of Earth's history?

Answer: No. The Earth is about 4.54 billion years old, while modern humans have existed for only about 300,000 years. Humans occupy only a tiny part of Earth's history.

### Q6. What is an era?

Answer: An era is a distinct period of time. A major event, such as the beginning of a ruler's reign, may mark the beginning of an era.

### Q7. What is a fossil?

Answer: A fossil is the preserved impression or remains of an ancient plant, animal or other living thing found in soil or rocks.

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# Topic B: People Who Study the Past

## Q1. Who are geologists?

Answer: Geologists study the physical features of the Earth, such as soil, rocks, hills, mountains, rivers and oceans.

## Q2. Who are palaeontologists?

Answer: Palaeontologists study fossils and the remains of plants, animals and humans from the distant past.

## Q3. Who are anthropologists?

Answer: Anthropologists study human societies and cultures from ancient times to the present.

## Q4. Who are archaeologists?

Answer: Archaeologists study the past by examining objects and remains left behind by people, such as tools, pots, beads, bones, toys and parts of houses.

## Q5. Who is a historian?

Answer: A historian is a person who studies and writes about the past.

## Q6. Who is an epigraphist?

Answer: An epigraphist is a person who studies ancient inscriptions.

## Q7. What is genetics?

Answer: Genetics is the branch of biology that studies how features and characteristics pass from one generation to the next.

## Q8. How do archaeologists help us understand the past?

Answer: They excavate and study ancient objects, buildings, tools, pottery and other remains. These objects provide information about the life of people in earlier times.

# Topic C: How Is Time Measured in History?

## Q1. How do we measure historical time?

Answer: We measure historical time using years, decades, centuries and millenniums. Timelines help us arrange events in the correct order.

## Q2. What is the Gregorian calendar?

Answer: The Gregorian calendar is the calendar commonly used around the world. It has 12 months and normally 365 days. A leap year has 366 days.

## Q3. What do AD and CE mean?

Answer:

- AD stands for Anno Domini, a traditional way of counting years after the birth of Jesus Christ.
- CE stands for Common Era. It uses the same year numbering as AD.

## Q4. What do BC and BCE mean?

Answer:

- BC means Before Christ.
- BCE means Before Common Era.

Both use the same year numbering.

## Q5. What is the difference between BCE and CE?

Answer: BCE refers to years before the conventional starting point of the Common Era. CE refers to years from that starting point onwards.

## Q6. Is there a year zero in the Gregorian calendar's historical year numbering?

Answer: No. The year 1 BCE is followed immediately by 1 CE.

## Q7. How do we calculate the years between a BCE date and a CE date?

Answer: Add the two year numbers and subtract 1 because there is no year zero.

Example: From 2 BCE to 2 CE:

$2 + 2 - 1 = 3$ years.

## Q8. What is a decade?

Answer: A decade is a period of 10 years.

## Q9. What is a century?

Answer: A century is a period of 100 years.

Example: The 21st century CE runs from 2001 to 2100 CE.

## Q10. What is a millennium?

Answer: A millennium is a period of 1,000 years.

Example: The 3rd millennium CE runs from 2001 to 3000 CE.

## Q11. Which years belong to the 3rd century BCE?

Answer: The 3rd century BCE includes the years 300 BCE to 201 BCE.

## Q12. Which years belong to the 1st millennium BCE?

Answer: The 1st millennium BCE includes the years 1000 BCE to 1 BCE.

## Q13. What is a timeline?

Answer: A timeline is a line that shows dates and events in chronological order.

## Q14. Why is a timeline useful in history?

Answer: A timeline helps us understand when events happened and the order in which they took place.

## Q15. What is the difference between a year, a decade, a century and a millennium?

| Term | Period |
|---|---|
| Year | 1 year |
| Decade | 10 years |
| Century | 100 years |
| Millennium | 1,000 years |

## Q16. What is a pañchānga?

Answer: A pañchānga is a traditional Indian calendar book. It gives information about dates, festivals, sunrise, sunset, eclipses and other astronomical events. Some pañchāngas also include weather predictions.

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### Q17. How are traditional Indian calendars prepared?

Answer: Many traditional Indian calendars use the positions of the Sun and the Moon to define the months of the year.

### Q18. Which event happened earlier: the birth of Buddha or the birth of Jesus?

Answer: The birth of Buddha happened earlier. The textbook gives approximately 560 BCE for Buddha's birth and places the birth of Jesus later.

## Topic D: Sources of History

### Q1. What is a source of history?

Answer: A source of history is a place, person, text or object from which we get information about a past event or period.

### Q2. Why are sources of history important?

Answer: Sources of history help us learn about past people, their lives, beliefs, cultures and achievements.

### Q3. What are the main sources of history?

Answer: The chapter groups historical sources into these main types:

1. Archaeological sources
2. Oral sources
3. Literary sources
4. Artistic sources
5. Scientific and technological sources

### Q4. What are archaeological sources?

Answer: Archaeological sources are objects and remains discovered through excavation or found at historical sites.

Examples: Coins, tools, weapons, pottery, ornaments, buildings, monuments, bones and remains of houses.

## Q5. What are oral sources?

Answer: Oral sources are information passed from person to person by speaking or through memory.

Examples: Folklore, family stories and genealogical information shared by relatives.

## Q6. What are literary sources?

Answer: Literary sources are written records that provide information about the past.

Examples: Manuscripts, historical texts, poems, plays, the Vedas, Itihasas, travelogues and historical chronicles.

## Q7. What are artistic sources?

Answer: Artistic sources are works of art that provide information about past societies.

Examples: Paintings, sculptures and panels.

## Q8. What are scientific and technological sources?

Answer: These sources include scientific studies and technical evidence that help us understand the past.

Examples: Studies of ancient climates, chemical analysis of excavated materials and genetic studies of ancient people.

## Q9. How do old coins help historians?

Answer: Old coins may provide information about rulers, symbols, trade, art and the economy of a period.

## Q10. How do monuments help us understand history?

Answer: Monuments provide information about architecture, art, beliefs, rulers and the skills of people in the past.

## Q11. How do inscriptions help historians?

Answer: Inscriptions are writings on materials such as stone or metal. They can provide information about rulers, events, donations and other aspects of past life.

## Q12. What are newspapers and electronic media used for in history?

Answer: Newspapers help historians study recent history. Television and the internet can also provide information about events from recent decades.

### Q13. What do historians do when sources give different information?

Answer: Historians compare the sources carefully and try to decide which source is more reliable.

### Q14. Why should historians use many sources?

Answer: Different sources may provide different details. Using many sources helps historians check information and develop a clearer understanding of the past.

### Q15. Can some parts of history remain unknown?

Answer: Yes. Some historical evidence may be missing or destroyed. Therefore, historians may not be able to know every detail about the past.

### Q16. How does science help historians?

Answer: Scientific studies of ancient climates, excavated materials and the genetics of ancient people provide additional information about the past.

### Q17. How can we find out about our family's past?

Answer: We can ask parents and grandparents and examine family photographs, diaries, identity documents and other family records.

### Q18. What is a family tree?

Answer: A family tree is a diagram that shows family members and their relationships across generations.

## Topic E: The Beginnings of Human History

### Q1. How did early humans live?

Answer: Early humans lived in groups. They searched for food and shelter and depended mainly on hunting animals and gathering edible plants and fruits.

### Q2. Why did early humans live in groups?

Answer: They lived in groups to help one another and face the challenges of nature.

### Q3. Where did early humans live?

Answer: Early humans lived in temporary camps, rock shelters and caves.

### Q4. How did early humans get food?

Answer: They hunted animals and gathered edible plants and fruits.

### Q5. What tools did early humans use?

Answer: They used stone axes, blades, arrowheads and other tools to make their lives easier.

### Q6. What was the importance of fire to early humans?

Answer: Early humans used fire as part of their daily life. It helped them meet some of their needs and made life easier.

### Q7. What are rock paintings?

Answer: Rock paintings are pictures made on rock surfaces. They may show humans, animals, simple figures or symbols.

### Q8. What do rock paintings tell us?

Answer: They provide clues about the activities, surroundings and artistic expression of early humans.

### Q9. What ornaments did early humans make?

Answer: They made ornaments such as stone or shell beads and pendants made from animal teeth.

### Q10. What is meant by an afterlife?

Answer: An afterlife means a life believed to begin after death.

### Q11. What do we know about early humans' beliefs?

Answer: The chapter says that early humans had certain beliefs about natural elements and possibly some idea of an afterlife.

### Q12. How did early humans communicate?

Answer: They communicated with one another using languages that are now lost.

# Topic F: The First Crops

## Q1. What was an Ice Age?

Answer: An Ice Age was a period when the Earth was very cold and much of its surface was covered with ice.

## Q2. When did the last Ice Age last, according to the chapter?

Answer: The last Ice Age lasted from over 100,000 years ago to around 12,000 years ago.

## Q3. What happened when the climate became warmer after the last Ice Age?

Answer: Some ice melted. The water increased the flow of rivers and eventually drained into the oceans.

## Q4. When did humans begin to cultivate crops?

Answer: After the climate became warmer and living conditions improved, humans in many parts of the world began settling down and cultivating cereals and grains.

## Q5. What is domestication of animals?

Answer: Domestication means keeping and raising animals for human use.

## Q6. Which animals did early farming communities domesticate?

Answer: They domesticated animals such as cattle and goats.

## Q7. Why did early communities settle near rivers?

Answer: Rivers provided water, and the nearby soil was often fertile. This made growing crops easier.

## Q8. What is agriculture?

Answer: Agriculture is the practice of growing crops and producing food from the land.

## Q9. How did farming change human life?

Answer: Farming allowed many people to settle in one place, produce food and build larger communities.

## Q10. Why did the population of early communities grow?

Answer: With more food available through farming and animal domestication, communities grew in size and number.

# Topic G: Growth of Villages and New Technologies

## Q1. What is a hamlet?

Answer: A hamlet is a small settlement or a small village.

## Q2. How did hamlets grow into villages and towns?

Answer: As communities grew, settlements became larger. Villages exchanged goods and developed links with other villages. Some eventually grew into towns.

## Q3. What was the role of chieftains?

Answer: Chieftains or leaders were responsible for the well-being of the people in their communities.

## Q4. What does welfare mean?

Answer: Welfare means health, prosperity and well-being.

## Q5. How did early communities work together?

Answer: People worked together for the welfare of the community. The chapter explains that land was collectively sown and harvested.

## Q6. What goods did early villages exchange?

Answer: They mainly exchanged food, clothing and tools.

## Q7. What is pottery?

Answer: Pottery is the making of pots and other objects from clay.

## Q8. How did metal use help early people?

Answer: The use of copper and later iron helped people make durable tools, everyday objects and ornaments.

## Q9. How did new technologies improve life?

Answer: New technologies helped people make better tools, useful objects and ornaments, making daily activities easier.

## Q10. How did early human societies become more complex?

Answer: Farming, animal domestication, settled villages, exchange of goods, leadership and new technologies made societies more complex over time.

# 3. Answers to Important “Think About It” and “Let’s Explore” Activities

## Activity 1: What is your earliest memory, and how can the past help us understand the present?

Sample Answer:

My earliest memory may be of an event from my childhood. Learning about the past helps us understand our family, society, traditions and the changes that have taken place over time.

## Activity 2: How can you collect information about three generations of your family?

Answer:

I can collect information by speaking to my parents, grandparents and other relatives. I can also examine old photographs, diaries, identity documents and family records. I can use this information to prepare a family tree.

## Activity 3: What information can old coins, clothes, jewellery, utensils and buildings provide?

Answer:

- Coins: Information about rulers, symbols, trade and the economy.
- Clothes: Information about dress and daily life.
- Jewellery: Information about ornaments, art and craftsmanship.
- Utensils: Information about cooking and daily activities.
- Old buildings: Information about architecture, construction and past societies.

These are examples of information that historians may investigate; the exact conclusions depend on the objects available.

## Activity 4: Identify activities shown in the rock-shelter picture on page 70.

Sample Answer:

The picture shows early humans engaged in activities such as hunting, preparing food, making or using tools, and painting on rock surfaces. The picture provides clues about their daily lives.

## Activity 5: Identify activities shown in the agricultural community picture on page 72.

Sample Answer:

The picture shows people living in a settlement, working in fields, tending animals, preparing food and carrying out daily activities. It represents a community that depended on farming and domesticated animals.

## Activity 6: Were the roles of men and women always fixed in early communities?

Answer:

No. We cannot be sure that men and women always performed only the activities shown in the pictures. The chapter explains that women may have helped prepare colours or paint rock surfaces, while men may have cooked or cared for children. The pictures provide limited information, so we should not assume that all people had the same roles.

## Activity 7: What can we learn from the timeline on pages 62–63?

Answer:

The timeline shows important events from the distant past to more recent times. It helps us understand the order of events and compare their dates. It also shows that the history of Earth is much longer than the history of modern humans.

## Activity 8: Mark the beginning of the 8th millennium BCE.

Answer:

The 8th millennium BCE began in 8000 BCE and continued through 7001 BCE.

## Activity 9: Create a timeline from 1900 CE to the current year.

Sample Answer:

A student's timeline may include the following events:

- 1900 CE — Beginning of the period shown.
- 2001 CE — Beginning of the 21st century.
- 2026 CE — Current year.

Students should add the birth years of their grandparents, parents, siblings and themselves using their actual family information.

# 4. Extra Important Questions for Examination

## Very Short Answer Questions

Q1. What is the study of the human past called?

Answer: History.

Q2. What is a period of ten years called?

Answer: A decade.

Q3. What is a period of one hundred years called?

Answer: A century.

Q4. What is a period of one thousand years called?

Answer: A millennium.

Q5. What is the study of ancient inscriptions called?

Answer: Epigraphy.

Q6. What is the study of fossils called in this chapter's context?

Answer: Palaeontology.

Q7. What were the main food-gathering activities of early humans?

Answer: Hunting and gathering.

Q8. Which metal did early people use before iron, according to the chapter?

Answer: Copper.

Q9. What is the common calendar used worldwide called?

Answer: The Gregorian calendar.

Q10. What is a traditional Indian calendar book called?

Answer: A pañchānga.

## Short Answer Questions

Q1. Why are historians like detectives?

Answer: Both collect clues, examine evidence and compare information to understand what happened. Historians use historical sources to reconstruct the past.

Q2. Why is it important to check historical sources?

Answer: Sources may be incomplete or may give different information. Checking several sources helps historians judge their reliability.

Q3. What is the difference between archaeological and literary sources?

Answer: Archaeological sources include objects and physical remains, such as tools, coins and buildings. Literary sources include written materials, such as manuscripts, poems and historical texts.

Q4. How did farming encourage settled life?

Answer: Farming provided a more regular source of food. People began to settle near fertile land and water sources, and communities became larger.

Q5. How did trade and exchange help villages?

Answer: Villages exchanged food, clothing and tools. These exchanges connected communities and helped some settlements grow into towns.

## Long Answer Questions

Q1. Explain the different sources of history.

Answer:

Historians use different sources to understand the past. Archaeological sources include coins, tools, pottery, monuments and human remains. Oral sources include folklore and family stories. Literary sources include manuscripts, poems, historical texts and travelogues. Artistic sources include paintings, sculptures and panels. Scientific and technological studies, such as the analysis of ancient materials and genetics, also provide useful evidence. By comparing these sources, historians try to reconstruct the past.

Q2. Describe the life of early humans.

Answer:

Early humans lived in groups and depended mainly on hunting and gathering. They lived in temporary camps, rock shelters and caves. They used fire and made tools such as stone axes, blades and arrowheads. They created rock paintings and simple ornaments. Later, as the climate

became warmer, many communities began farming and domesticating animals. They settled near rivers, built villages, exchanged goods and developed new technologies.

Q3. Explain how human communities developed from small settlements into towns.

Answer:

Early humans began to settle down and grow crops. They domesticated animals and produced more food. Communities grew in size, and leaders helped look after people's welfare. Small settlements developed into villages. Villages exchanged food, clothing and tools with one another. Some settlements became towns. Pottery and the use of copper and iron helped people make durable tools and useful objects.

# 5. Important Dates and Facts to Remember

| Fact | Answer |
|---|---|
| Age of the Earth | About 4.54 billion years |
| Approximate time modern humans have lived on Earth | 300,000 years |
| Approximate birth year of Buddha used in the chapter | 560 BCE |
| Last Ice Age ended around | 12,000 years ago |
| Length of a decade | 10 years |
| Length of a century | 100 years |
| Length of a millennium | 1,000 years |
| Beginning of the 21st century CE | 2001 CE |
| Beginning of the 3rd millennium CE | 2001 CE |
| Year 1 BCE is followed by | 1 CE |

# 6. Important Definitions

| Word | Simple meaning |
|---|---|
| History | Study of the human past |
| Era | A distinct period of time |
| Fossil | Preserved remains or impressions of ancient living things |
| Historian | A person who studies and writes about the past |
| Archaeologist | A person who studies the past through material remains |
| Anthropologist | A person who studies human societies and cultures |
| Geologist | A person who studies the physical features of the Earth |
| Palaeontologist | A person who studies fossils |
| Timeline | A line showing events in chronological order |
| Source of history | A person, place, text or object that provides information about the past |

| | |
|---|---|
| Decade | A period of 10 years |
| Century | A period of 100 years |
| Millennium | A period of 1,000 years |
| Agriculture | Growing crops and producing food from the land |
| Domestication | Keeping and raising animals for human use |
| Hamlet | A small settlement or village |
| Welfare | Health, prosperity and well-being |
| Afterlife | A life believed to begin after death |

Revision tip: Students should especially practise the BCE/CE date calculations, the difference between the types of historical sources, the roles of geologists, palaeontologists, anthropologists and archaeologists, and the changes from hunting and gathering to farming and village life.